



LME KNITTING PATTERN



RO BUCKET HAT FOR BABY AND CHILD, DUPLICATE STITCH



WHITE WITH BLUE RO, FLAG AND WAVES • SIZE 50-170

The same RO bucket hat as the pattern for adults: a white cotton hat with the Norwegian flag and "RO" in blue at the front, and two blue waves at the back, with a solid blue brim that flares at the edge. Here you knit the whole main body in a single white colour first, then add the motifs at the end with duplicate stitch, instead of knitting them in as you go. Graded completely from scratch into twenty-one baby, child and teen sizes, 50 to 170. This pattern is complete on its own, you do not need any other LME pattern to knit it.



By Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com



TIPS: Read the whole pattern once before you cast on. Always knit a gauge swatch first, see page 4.

BEFORE YOU START

The bucket hat is knitted in the round on a circular needle or double-pointed needles, from the bottom up, in white main colour. You start with a blue brim that flares, then knit the whole main body in plain white, and finally decrease the crown down to a small rounded top. Right at the end you embroider "RO" and the flag at the front, and two waves at the back, with duplicate stitch (also called Swiss darning), a stitch that sits on top of the knitting and looks knitted in.

WHAT YOU LEARN

- To knit a hat in the round on a circular needle or double-pointed needles
- To knit a blue, flared brim with a decrease round
- To embroider two different motifs (RO+flag at front, waves at back) with duplicate stitch, following charts
- To decrease a rounded crown evenly down to a few stitches

HOW HARD IS IT?

Beginner friendly. You should be able to cast on, knit stockinette in the round and change colour. The main body is knitted in just white, the motifs come on afterwards with a needle and thread, and every step is spelled out in this pattern.

Use double-pointed needles or magic loop for the smallest sizes (50-86). An ordinary circular needle is often too long for the stitches to reach round.

SIZES AND GETTING THE FIT RIGHT

The clothing size is only a guide. Always measure around the child's head, above the ears and eyebrows. Go by the head measurement if it and the clothing size point to different sizes.

Size	Approx. age	Head (cm)
50	0-1 mo	34-36
56	1-2 mo	36-38
62	2-4 mo	38-40
68	4-6 mo	40-42
74	6-9 mo	42-44
80	9-12 mo	44-46
86	12-18 mo	46-48
92	18-24 mo	48-50
98	2-3 yr	49-51
104	3-4 yr	50-52
110	4-5 yr	51-53
116	5-6 yr	52-53
122	6-7 yr	52-54
128	7-8 yr	53-54
134	8-9 yr	53-55
140	9-10 yr	54-55
146	10-11 yr	54-56
152	11-12 yr	55-56
158	12-13 yr	55-57
164	13-14 yr	56-57
170	14-16 yr	56-58

SAFE USE FOR THE YOUNGEST

The hat is a garment for supervised, awake use. It should not be used during sleep, in a cot, in a pram unattended, or if the brim covers the eyes, nose or mouth. Always check that no loose threads or long floats on the inside can catch on little fingers.

Children grow at different rates. The actual head measurement always beats age, measure again whenever you are unsure.

WHAT YOU NEED

YARN

A smooth cotton yarn (aran weight) that gives 17 stitches x 22 rounds in stockinette = 10 x 10 cm on 5 mm needles. Reynolds Saucy, Rico Design Creative Cotton Aran and Hobbii Amigo are all good choices, in white/natural, royal blue and a little red.

Colour

Use

○ White/natural	main colour, whole main body
● Royal blue	whole brim, embroidery: RO, the waves
● Red	embroidery: the flag
● Navy	embroidery: the flag

Have plenty of white main colour (almost the whole hat is knitted in white) and a little royal blue for the brim, plus a little royal blue, red and navy for the embroidery.

NEEDLES AND KIT

- 5 mm circular needle, 40 cm, or 5 mm double-pointed needles/magic loop set
- **Tapestry needle with a blunt tip** for the embroidery, a sharp needle can split the yarn
- Scissors and tape measure
- Stitch marker (optional, to track centre front and centre back)

**If you knit tightly, try 5.5 mm needles. If you knit loosely, try 4.5 mm.
The target is always 17 stitches over 10 cm.**

GAUGE, THE SECRET KEY

KNIT A SWATCH FIRST

Cast on 30 stitches in the main colour. Knit stockinette in the round (or back and forth with an edge) until the swatch is at least 12 x 12 cm. Wash and dry it the way you plan to treat the hat, then measure across the middle.

- More than 17 stitches over 10 cm: try a thicker needle.
- Fewer than 17 stitches over 10 cm: try a thinner needle.
- Exactly 17 stitches: use 5 mm needles and get going.

GLOSSARY

Term	Means
st	stitch
round	one whole lap around
k	knit
k2tog	knit 2 stitches together, decreases one stitch
MC	main colour (white)
duplicate stitch	embroidery that sits on top of the knit stitches and looks knitted in, also called Swiss darning
evenly spaced	spread equally around the round, not bunched in one spot

PART 1: CAST ON AND KNIT THE BRIM

- 1 Find the number for your size in the "Cast on" column in the table on the next page. Cast on exactly that many stitches in royal blue.
- 2 Check that the cast-on edge is not twisted around the needle. Join in the round and place a stitch marker at the start of the round (centre back), this is where every round begins and ends.
- 3 Knit the whole brim in royal blue, in stockinette in the round (knit every stitch), for the number of rounds in the "Brim rounds" column on the next page. No colour changes in the brim.
- 4 On the very last brim round, knit 2 stitches together all the way round (stitch 1 and 2 together, stitch 3 and 4 together, and so on). This halves the stitch count exactly, from your cast-on number down to the "Main body" number on the next page. This round is what creates the flared edge.
- 5 Switch to white main colour. From here you knit the rest of the hat plain white, the motifs come on afterwards with embroidery.

THE FLARED EDGE

The decrease round is what gives the brim its characteristic flared, wavy edge, it is normal for the edge to curl in a little until the hat has been worn a few times.

TABLE: THE BRIM, ALL SIZES

Size	Cast on	Brim rounds	Brim colour
50	116	6	Royal blue, solid
56	122	7	Royal blue, solid
62	130	8	Royal blue, solid
68	136	9	Royal blue, solid
74	144	10	Royal blue, solid
80	150	11	Royal blue, solid
86	156	12	Royal blue, solid
92	162	13	Royal blue, solid
98	166	13	Royal blue, solid
104	170	13	Royal blue, solid
110	172	13	Royal blue, solid
116	174	13	Royal blue, solid
122	176	14	Royal blue, solid
128	178	14	Royal blue, solid
134	178	14	Royal blue, solid
140	180	15	Royal blue, solid
146	182	15	Royal blue, solid
152	184	15	Royal blue, solid
158	186	15	Royal blue, solid
164	188	16	Royal blue, solid
170	190	16	Royal blue, solid

Use double-pointed needles or magic loop for the whole brim on the smallest sizes, it is too narrow for an ordinary circular needle.

PART 2: THE MAIN BODY

- 1 After the decrease round, knit stockinette in the round in the white main colour, all the way, with no pattern. This is now the main body of the hat, the part that shows the most.
- 2 Knit plain until the whole main body measures the "Height to top" value in the table on the next page, measured from the decrease round. Do not worry about the motifs yet, you embroider those on at the end, see Part 3 on the next spread.

TABLE: MAIN BODY

Size	Stitches (main body)	Height to top
50	58	5.5 cm
56	61	6 cm
62	65	6.5 cm
68	68	7 cm
74	72	7.5 cm
80	75	8 cm
86	78	8.5 cm
92	81	9 cm
98	83	9 cm
104	85	9 cm
110	86	9.5 cm
116	87	9.5 cm
122	88	10 cm
128	89	10 cm
134	89	10.5 cm
140	90	10.5 cm
146	91	10.5 cm
152	92	11 cm
158	93	11 cm
164	94	11 cm
170	95	11 cm

The motifs are embroidered in the middle of the main body height, not right down against the brim and not right up at the top. More about that on the next page.

PART 3: HOW TO EMBROIDER THE MOTIFS

The hat is now fully knitted, all white. You add the motifs with duplicate stitch: a stitch that sits on top of the knitted stitches and looks knitted in. One square in the chart on the next page is one stitch on the hat. Use the blunt tapestry needle and a length of yarn about 40–50 cm.

HOW TO WORK ONE STITCH

1

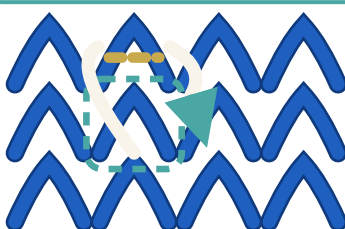
come up here



Bring the needle up from below, at the base of the stitch (the root of the V).

2

under the stitch above



Pass the needle under both legs of the stitch right above. Pull the yarn through.

3

down the same hole



Bring the needle down into the same hole you came up. Done! The blue V now lies on top of the white stitch.

GOOD TIPS

- Do not pull the yarn tight. The V should sit loose and relaxed on top of the stitch, not tight.
- Embroider row by row: finish one horizontal row of the chart before moving up to the next.
- Leave a 5 cm tail hanging on the inside at the start and end, weave in the ends when you are done.
- Count squares in the chart and stitches on the hat with your finger, twice if needed. Counting right is half the job.

A stitch come out wrong? Just pull it gently back out and try again.

THE CHARTS AND PLACEMENT

HOW TO PLACE THE MOTIFS

Count the stitches around and find centre front (opposite the stitch marker, which sits at centre back). RO is 15 stitches wide, centre it around centre front. Embroider the flag about 2 rounds above RO, centred. Embroider the waves at the same height as RO, one on each side of centre back, with a little white in between.

CHART: RO (7 STITCHES PER LETTER X 9 ROUNDS)

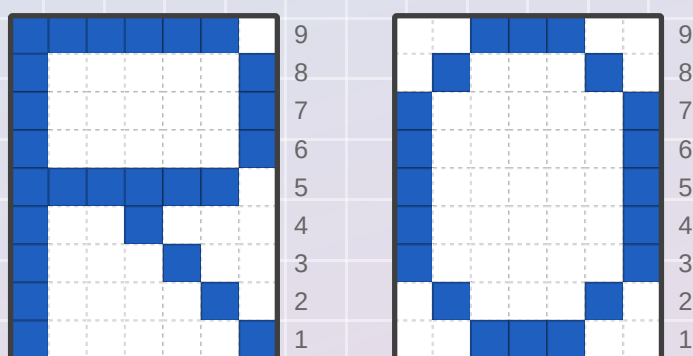


CHART: THE FLAG (13 STITCHES X 10 ROUNDS)

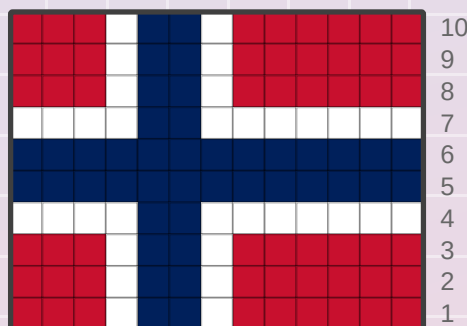
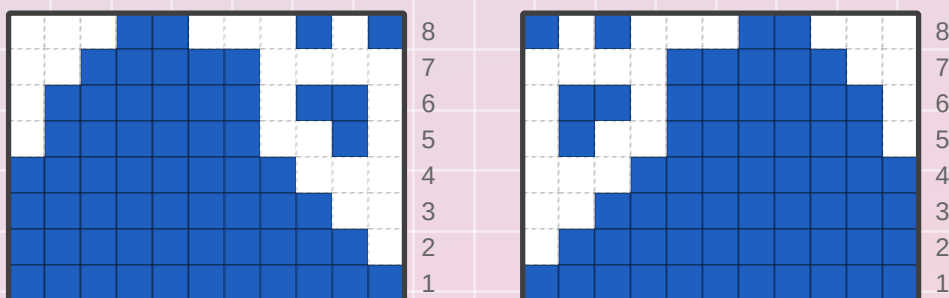


CHART: THE WAVES, BACK (11 STITCHES X 8 ROUNDS, ONE MIRRORED)



Read all charts from the bottom up, just like the stitches in the knitting. Work each row from right to left. Coloured square = embroider that colour. Dashed white square = skip it, the main colour shows through with no embroidery.

PART 4: THE CROWN

- 1** When the main body measures the value in the table on page 8, knit one setup round: decrease the number of stitches given in the "Decrease" column in the table on the next page, evenly spaced around the whole round. If it says "No decrease", skip this round and go straight to the next step.
- 2** Divide the remaining stitches into 7 equal sections. Place a stitch marker between each section (7 markers in total, plus the one at the start of the round).
- 3** Knit to 2 stitches before each marker, knit these 2 together. Repeat at all 7 markers, giving 7 decreases per round.
- 4** Sizes 50–68: knit 1 plain round with no decreases after the first 3 decrease rounds, then decrease on every round after that. Sizes 74–170: knit 1 plain round after the first 4 decrease rounds, then decrease every round after that.
- 5** Continue until 7 stitches (one per section) remain. Cut the yarn leaving a generous tail, thread it through the remaining stitches with a tapestry needle, pull tight and fasten off securely on the inside.

TABLE: SETUP BEFORE THE CROWN, ALL SIZES

Size	Stitches before top	Decrease	Stitches after
50	58	Dec 2 st	56
56	61	Dec 5 st	56
62	65	Dec 2 st	63
68	68	Dec 5 st	63
74	72	Dec 2 st	70
80	75	Dec 5 st	70
86	78	Dec 1 st	77
92	81	Dec 4 st	77
98	83	Dec 6 st	77
104	85	Dec 1 st	84
110	86	Dec 2 st	84
116	87	Dec 3 st	84
122	88	Dec 4 st	84
128	89	Dec 5 st	84
134	89	Dec 5 st	84
140	90	Dec 6 st	84
146	91	No decrease	91
152	92	Dec 1 st	91
158	93	Dec 2 st	91
164	94	Dec 3 st	91
170	95	Dec 4 st	91

CARE AND FINAL CHECK

FINISHING

Weave in all loose ends securely on the inside, both after the brim and after the embroidery. Check that the embroidered stitches lie loose on top of the knitting, not tight.

CARE

Wash following the yarn's recommendation, often 30°C on a gentle cycle in a wash bag, or by hand. Do not tumble dry. Shape the hat over a bowl or glass of the right size and let it dry flat or on the form.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ The head measurement has been checked, not just age
- ☐ The swatch matches 17 stitches x 22 rounds over 10 cm
- ☐ The brim has the flared edge from the decrease round
- ☐ RO and the flag are embroidered at centre front, the waves at centre back
- ☐ All embroidered stitches lie loose, not tight
- ☐ The top is pulled tight and well fastened off

Congratulations, you have knitted and embroidered your very own RO bucket hat!



Renate Dahl

Little Montessori Explorers

lmexplorers.com

© 2026 Little Montessori Explorers. This pattern is for personal use only. The pattern and charts may not be copied, shared, resold or published. Finished items may be sold on a small scale with credit to Little Montessori Explorers.

The hat is a garment for supervised, awake use. Do not use during sleep or in a pram unattended.